

Pop art

After the austerity of the Second World War, mass production, mass media and consumerism proliferated in America and Europe. Beginning as a revolt against attitudes towards art, Pop art emerged in London and New York in the mid-1950s and 60s. Many Pop artists perceived Abstract Expressionism as being self-indulgent, and most were critical of capitalism and art snobbery.

Pop artists used everyday, mass media sources such as Hollywood, advertising, packaging, pop music and comics, declaring that art can borrow from any source, that it's art if the artist says it is, that art is for everyone and has no boundaries. Pop artists also explored several non-traditional, commercial methods of production. A shared notion was that the art should present ideas impersonally and objectively, with no emphasis on feelings or symbolism. Pop artists include Andy Warhol, Roy Lichtenstein, Richard Hamilton (1922–2011), Peter Blake (b.1932), Jasper Johns (b.1930), David Hockney, Claes Oldenburg (b.1929), Patrick Caulfield (1936–2005), and Eduardo Paolozzi (1924–2005).



Hamilton, *Just What is it That Makes Today's Homes So Different, So Appealing?*, 1956